The New Luxury Is Indian: Dr. Payal Bansal Kanodia's Vision of Reclaiming Heritage and Craftsmanship

Through M3M Foundation, Dr. Payal Bansal Kanodia is bringing together heritage conservation, sustainable art and contemporary fashion to demonstrate how India's extraordinary cultural inheritance can become a source of economic opportunity, creative distinction and enduring social value.



Dr. Payal Bansal Kanodia
Chairperson & Trustee, M3M Foundation
Chairperson, Paralympic Committee of India (PCI)
Chairperson, Swanath Parishad, Vish Mangalya Sabha (VMS)

Luxury has always been about more than price. Its true currency lies in provenance, rarity, craftsmanship and the human ingenuity invested in creating something exceptional. Yet, for decades, the global vocabulary of luxury has been shaped largely by Western maisons that have successfully transformed specialist craftsmanship, exclusive materials and centuries-old traditions into powerful commercial identities. India, however, has never lacked these ingredients. From the intricacy of Banarasi weaving and the delicacy of Chikankari to its metalwork, stone carving, textiles and indigenous art forms, the country possesses an extraordinary inheritance of craftsmanship. What has often been missing is not talent, but visibility; not artistic excellence, but market access and the institutional support required to translate heritage into contemporary economic value.

It is this opportunity that informs the vision of Dr. Payal Bansal Kanodia, Chairperson and Trustee of M3M Foundation. Through a series of initiatives spanning heritage restoration, environmental art and artisanal entrepreneurship, she is advancing a more inclusive understanding of luxury one rooted in India's cultural identity, creative intelligence and human potential.

For her, the future of luxury lies not in imitation, but in rediscovering the extraordinary value of what India has always known how to create.

In Tauru, Haryana, the restoration of a **historic tomb** reflects M3M Foundation's commitment to safeguarding India's lesser-known architectural heritage. For Dr. Kanodia, whose ancestral roots lie in Tauru, the initiative carries a deeply personal resonance. It recognises that the cultural identity of a nation is preserved not only through its celebrated monuments, but also through the historic structures and local landmarks that hold generations of collective memory.

In Gurugram, the Foundation has expressed a different but equally compelling dimension of this philosophy. Through ***Sculpting Sustainability,*** discarded industrial materials have been transformed into artistic sculptures and installations across the Delhi-NCR region. What might otherwise have been treated as waste has acquired a new aesthetic and environmental purpose, bringing the principles of circularity and responsible consumption into the public realm.

These interventions reflect a common